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TECH SAVVY: AFMC is the only college to use medical simulation

While other colleges face difficulty in procuring cadavers, AFMC is able to provide them to students."

Leaders never give up their quest for excellence. Each one of the colleges figuring in the top 25 list is a winner. They do not sit pretty on their laurels. The HIV Centre at Grant Medical College, Mumbai, the oldest in the country, has been chosen by the government as a centre for excellence. Under a Rs 100-crore project, the hospital is being computerised so that data from hospitals across the state will be available on its server. Next year should see more surprises from this dark horse, which has moved up two ranks from No. 8.

Medical colleges are adopting cutting-edge technology to impart quality medical education. CMC, Vellore, which takes in 60 undergraduates—of which at least 25 are women—every year, has been given a five-star rating by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council, an autonomous institution of the University Grants Commission, in recognition of the edu-

cation and healthcare it provides. It has also been categorised as a super-speciality teaching hospital and assigned H1 grading by the Investment Information and Credit Rating Agency, implying that it has the resources and processes required for delivering quality care. CMC's success is also due to its excellent faculty, with 550 of them teaching 648 students.

The hospital at CMC, Vellore has 2,340 beds and serves 15 lakh outpatients annually. It is training general physicians in administering Anti Retro Viral Therapy for HIV-infected persons. "We train medical personnel from Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Bangladesh, Nepal and other countries," says Dr Anand Job, principal, CMC. The college is also an important centre for animal and human clinical trials. Its pediatric department is now working on a vaccine against diarrhoea-causing roto virus.

When it comes to new technology, AFMC stays ahead of the curve. Last year, it became the first college to use medical simulation to teach students how to deal with emergencies. The Human Patient Simulator, which can be tuned to create any life-threatening emergency, eliminates the risk of caus-

ing damage to human life while administering experimental treatment. Says Lieutenant-General S.K. Kaul, director and commandant of AFMC, "We are the first in the country to have this kind of a facility." The college combines technology with human interaction and employs the best faculty.

In AFMC's diamond jubilee year, a new Bionic Ear Centre has been established in the campus in collaboration with the Defence Bioengineering and Electromedical Laboratory, Bangalore. The centre offers cochlear ear transplants for patients who have lost their hearing due to nerve-related disorders. The next few months will see India's first DNA bank and a DNA profiling centre come up within the campus. Having submitted a gene sequence to the International Gene Bank, the college now wants to make its mark in genetics as well. Its Malignant Diseases Treatment Centre has started autologous stem cell transplants for multiple myelomas and lymphomas. Evidently, a lot can happen in a year, because excellence is not an end in itself but an ongoing journey.

with Jhilmili Motihar, Shruti Maheshwari and S. Senthil Kumar